Bernardo Reyes

Visual identity guidelines · v0.1 first draft

A bold, structured, warm identity: Colombian modernism meeting Constructivist graphic design.

01

Moodboard and intent

The identity starts from three sources. Each one contributes a rule: the posters give the bold type and diagonals, Bogotá gives warm color and brick, and old print gives the handmade texture.

Soviet Constructivist posters, VKhUTEMAS type, and Bogotá modernism street scenes
Constructivism and print. Red, black, cream, heavy angled type.

Bogotá modernism towers, Salmona brick architecture, and Colombian book covers
Bogotá modernism. Brick towers, terracotta, 1970s street photos.

Old engravings, a La Fontaine cover, a catechism page, and Bauhaus furniture
Old print and Bauhaus. Engravings, serif type, primary colors.

Intent

- **Bold.** Heavy display type and strong color blocks.
- **Structured.** A 12-column grid and one diagonal rule.
- **Warm.** Terracotta, cream, and wood tones over cold white.
- **A little handmade.** Old print serifs and imperfect edges.

Crown

Crown and transitions

The red crown and the red crane truss are the two transition elements. Use it to move the reader from one section to the next: the crown slides in from the left at the top of each section and the crane truss slides in from the right at the bottom. Use them to mark a page turn, a project cover, or a link. Keep the motion short and simple, and turn it off for readers who ask for reduced motion.

Crown mark

Do: use the crown in Constructivist Red, on cream or ink, at least 24 px tall.

Don't: separate the crown from the letters in the main logo, or rotate it to a new angle.

02

Logo

The logo is BERNIE: a red crown mark beside black letters, traced from the original artwork. The crown is also the transition element for the whole system (see Crown below).

Full color wordmark

Full color

Monochrome wordmark

Monochrome

Reversed wordmark on ink

Reversed

Clear space and minimum size

Wordmark with clear space around it

Keep clear space equal to the height of the crown on all sides.

Minimum size. 120 px wide on screen. 30 mm wide in print.

Wordmark at minimum size

Misuse

Stretched wordmark
Do not stretch or squash.

Wordmark rotated
Do not rotate or change the angle.

Wordmark in off-palette blue
Do not recolor outside the palette.

Wordmark with drop shadow
Do not add shadows or effects.

Red wordmark on red background
Do not place the red wordmark on red.

03

Color

Six colors, all from the moodboard. Use Ink Black and Paper Cream for most text and backgrounds. Use Constructivist Red for emphasis. Use the others as accents.

Constructivist Red

Headlines, key accents, and the crown.

HEX
#EC4537
RGB
236, 69, 55
CMYK
0, 71, 77, 7

From: The BERNIE logo

Ink Black

Text and structure.

HEX
#201A21
RGB
32, 26, 33
CMYK
3, 21, 0, 87

From: Panel 1 and the book covers

Paper Cream

Page background.

HEX
#FBFAF2
RGB
251, 250, 242
CMYK
0, 0, 4, 2

From: Catechism and Lenin posters

Brick Terracotta

Secondary accent.

HEX
#CA7C46
RGB
202, 124, 70
CMYK
0, 39, 65, 21

From: Salmona-style brick, panel 2

Bauhaus Yellow

Small accents and highlights.

HEX
#D9AC33
RGB
217, 172, 51
CMYK
0, 21, 76, 15

From: Nesting tables and posters

Warm Gray

Captions and secondary text.

HEX
#888378
RGB
136, 131, 120
CMYK
0, 4, 12, 47

From: Neutral gray across the board

CMYK values are approximate conversions. Confirm with a printer proof before a print run.

Contrast (WCAG 2.1)

Each cell shows the contrast of the row color used as text on the column color used as background. AA means 4.5:1 or higher, which passes for all text. Large only means 3:1 or higher, which passes only for headings of 24px and up.

Text ↓ / Background →	Constructivist Red	Ink Black	Paper Cream	Brick Terracotta	Bauhaus Yellow	Warm Gray
Constructivist Red	—	4.45 Large only	3.66 Large only	1.18 Fail	1.81 Fail	1.02 Fail
Ink Black	4.45 Large only	—	16.29 AA	5.27 AA	8.04 AA	4.52 AA
Paper Cream	3.66 Large only	16.29 AA	—	3.09 Large only	2.03 Fail	3.60 Large only
Brick Terracotta	1.18 Fail	5.27 AA	3.09 Large only	—	1.53 Fail	1.17 Fail
Bauhaus Yellow	1.81 Fail	8.04 AA	2.03 Fail	1.53 Fail	—	1.78 Fail
Warm Gray	1.02 Fail	4.52 AA	3.60 Large only	1.17 Fail	1.78 Fail	—

Text pairs for body text (AA, 4.5:1 or higher): Ink on Cream, Cream on Ink, Yellow on Ink, Terracotta on Ink, and Warm Gray on Ink (4.5:1, just passing).

Large headings only (24 px and up, 3:1 or higher): Red on Cream (3.7:1), Cream on Red (3.7:1), Terracotta on Cream (3.1:1), and Warm Gray on Cream (3.6:1).

Not for text: Red on Ink (4.45:1) misses AA by a small margin, so use it for shapes, the crown, and large headings only. Yellow on Cream (2.0:1) fails, so use Yellow as a shape or on Ink.

04

Typography

Three typefaces, each with one job. Anton for display. EB Garamond for reading text. IBM Plex Mono for captions and labels. All three include Spanish accents.

Display · Anton · 104 px

Diseño de servicios

Heading 1 · Anton · 64 px

Bogotá en la ciudad

Heading 2 · Anton · 40 px

Proyecto de servicio

Lead · EB Garamond · 22 px

Un sistema visual sólido, cálido y un poco artesanal.

Body · EB Garamond · 18 px · line height 1.6

Las ciudades cambian con el tiempo. El diseño de servicios ayuda a entender cómo las personas viven, se mueven y encuentran lo que necesitan.

Caption · IBM Plex Mono · 13 px · uppercase

Foto: Bogotá, años 70 · Portafolio 2026

Hierarchy rules

- One display line per layout. Keep it short.
- Body text stays in EB Garamond. Never set body text in Anton.
- Captions and labels are uppercase Plex Mono, 13 px at minimum.

05

Grid

One grid for every layout, from phone to desktop. The grid is built from tokens, and the diagonal is the single rule that breaks it on purpose.

Wide block
Narrow
Narrow

Show grid

Columns	4 below 768 px · 8 from 768 px · 12 from 1024 px
Gutter	16px below 768 px · 24px from 768 px
Margin	16px below 768 px · 24px from 768 px
Max width	1200px
Diagonal	15deg tilt on key elements only

06

Applied examples

Three uses of the system. The copy is sample text.

Diseño de servicios

Portafolio · Service Design

Portfolio cover (4:5)

Project 01 · Bogotá · Service design

Un mapa de la ciudad

My role
Research and service blueprint
Overview
How residents move through public services
Research goal
Find where the journey breaks
Impact
Three service changes proposed

Project slide (16:9)

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LinkedIn banner (4:1)

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